

THE VIRTUOUS GIRL

The Mother's Checklist

*Five signs your daughter is approaching her first period
— and what to have ready before the day comes*

A calm, practical guide for mothers who want their daughter's first period to arrive as a moment of readiness — not fear, not shame, and not surprise.

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Before the Day Comes

Most girls today reach their first period between the ages of 10 and 15, with 12 being about average — and it can arrive earlier. The girls who handle that day with confidence are almost never the ones who knew the most biology. They are the ones whose mothers saw it coming and prepared them.

The good news: your daughter's body gives you signals, usually one to two years in advance. This checklist walks you through the five signs to watch for, then gives you a simple preparation list so that when the day arrives, both of you are ready.

A note for the Muslim mother: in our deen, a girl's first period is not an embarrassment — it is the day she becomes accountable before Allah, a doorway into womanhood that deserves dignity and even celebration. Preparation is how you give her that dignity.

The Five Signs

SIGN ONE

Her chest begins to develop

Breast budding is usually the very first signal — small, sometimes tender bumps beneath the nipple, often starting on one side before the other. For most girls, the first period follows roughly two to two-and-a-half years after this begins. When you notice it, your preparation window has opened.

SIGN TWO

A sudden growth spurt

If she has shot up in height over the past year — outgrowing shoes and clothes faster than usual — take note. The first period typically arrives after a girl's fastest growth has passed, often within about a year of it.

SIGN THREE

New body hair

Hair appearing under the arms and in the private area is a sign that her hormones are actively at work. It usually appears after breast development begins and moves her another step closer.

SIGN FOUR

Discharge in her underwear

A small amount of whitish or clear discharge often begins about six to twelve months before the first period. Many mothers miss this sign — and many girls quietly worry about it. If you see it in the laundry, the first period is likely close. Reassure her that it is her body's natural self-cleaning, and begin your final preparations.

SIGN FIVE

Your own history — and her changing moods

Daughters often begin within a year or so of the age their mother began. Think back to your own age — it is one of the most useful predictors you have. Alongside it, you may notice new emotional weather: quicker tears, sharper frustration, more need for privacy. Hormones are speaking before the body does.

What to Have Ready

Check each item off as you prepare it. The goal is simple: on the day it happens, nothing needs to be bought, found, or explained in a panic.

- ☐ **A small kit for her backpack.** A discreet zip pouch with two or three pads and a spare pair of underwear. If it starts at school, she is ready — not embarrassed.
- ☐ **Safe pads at home.** Choose organic cotton pads — chlorine-free, fragrance-free, no harsh chemicals — in a light and a regular absorbency. Show her where they are kept.
- ☐ **Dark-colored underwear.** A few comfortable, 100% cotton pairs in dark colors. Practical, and it spares her worry over stains.
- ☐ **A hot water bottle or heating pad.** The single most comforting tool for cramps. Warmth on the belly for fifteen to twenty minutes works wonders.
- ☐ **An iron-friendly pantry.** Dates, eggs, spinach, red meat or chicken, and orange juice (vitamin C helps iron absorb). Her body will be working harder; feed it well.
- ☐ **A period tracker.** A small calendar of her own — teach her to mark the first day. Cycles are irregular in the first year or two; the calendar builds calm and knowledge.
- ☐ **The conversation — before the day.** The most important item on this list. She should hear what a period is, from you, before she ever sees one. Ten warm minutes now prevents years of quiet fear.
- ☐ **The deen, gently.** Let her know ahead of time, in simple terms: when it comes, she will pause prayer and fasting during those days — not as punishment, but as Allah's mercy and rest — and she will make up missed fasts later.

If You Don't Know How to Start

You do not need a perfect speech. You need one honest opening. Try one of these, in your own words, at a quiet moment — in the car, while cooking, before bed:

“You’re growing up, masha’Allah — and there’s something every woman goes through that I want you to hear about from me first.”

“When I was around your age, my body started changing too. Can I tell you what to expect, so nothing ever surprises you?”

Keep it short the first time. Let her ask questions. Leave the door open. The goal of the first conversation is only this: she learns that this subject is safe to bring to you.

Let Her Learn the Rest Like a Storybook

This checklist prepares *you*. To prepare *her*, The Virtuous Girl offers **The Muslim Girl: A Guide to Puberty and Purity** by Fatima Ezzahra Muhammad — a fully illustrated twelve-chapter course for girls ages 8 and up. She follows a girl her own age through every question: what is happening to her body, how to care for herself with safe and natural products, how purity, prayer, and fasting work, and how to step into womanhood with confidence instead of shame. Every chapter ends with a short review and a “Talk to Mama” question that brings the conversation back to you.

Enrollment opens soon at thevirtuousgirl.com — you are already on the list.

This guide is educational and is not medical advice. If your daughter has severe pain, very heavy bleeding, or no signs of development by age 13–14, speak with her doctor.